

Today, a lot of companies are using DevOps (Development + Operations) to push software continually by integrating development, testing and release cycles even closer together. Because of these, the responsibilities of software testers are becoming even more tightly integrated with other teams.

Software testing is very crucial. Imagine rolling out your software, only to find a long line of angry and frustrated customers banging at your door complaining about a bug, or lag or any other sub-optimal performance. Such a perception can quickly snowball into a massive PR issue for your company.

Proper software testing will ensure that your product will work and function as advertised and as desired, and this is key to ensuring the success of your sales and marketing efforts. A customer happy with your product performance will not only be more loyal – resulting in increased CLV – but also is more likely to recommend your product to others.

What skills do you need to succeed?

Having a repertoire of both the necessary technical and non-technical skills is essential to succeed with this.

Non-technical skills

The following non-technical skills are important for growing in your career as a reliable software tester.

Strong analytical skills – Good analytical skills will keep you on good stead with the responsibilities needed as a part of the task. Analytical skills are necessary to break the more massive task, or sophisticated software, into smaller chunks on which test cases can be built.

Communication skills – Strong communication are integral to succeeding and growing. While starting out in your career, you may work as a part of the larger team, working on the back-end and acquiring the necessary technical skills to carry out your tasks. But as you grow, you will be increasingly required to strategize, develop schedules and plan which will be shared within the team and with external shareholders as well.

To do this well, you need to learn to express your ideas lucidly. Not only this, as a part of the testing team, you will also often have to start discussions with the software development team.

Time management and organisation abilities – Testing can incorporate a highly demanding set of tasks – especially during times of product release and delivery. You will have to manage the high workloads, ensure high productivity, exhibit time management skills, and organisational abili-